

The Game Changers INDIVIDUALS

SUJATHA RAMDORAI 47 PROFESSOR, Tata Institute of Fundamental Research, Mumbai

THE RIGHT TANGENT

She is one of India's finest mathematicians and when you ask her what it entails, she says "it's long periods of sitting by yourself, grappling with a problem, with paper and pencil in hand". And yet, Sujatha Ramdorai is a great proponent of mathematics as a useful tool in daily life, for instance, calculus in control theory and absolute mathematics in mobile communications. "The problem in India is that nerds are not cool, but geeks are," she says with a laugh. Belying the myth that mathematics is a male domain, she says 10 per cent of the department at Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR) is female though she admits that there is little connect between the top research institutes, the colleges and schools. As winner of the 2006 Ramanujan Prize given to young mathematicians in

Education Ph.D from TIFR/Bombay University.

Lives for Understanding the beauty in mathematical results, like Fermat's last theorem.

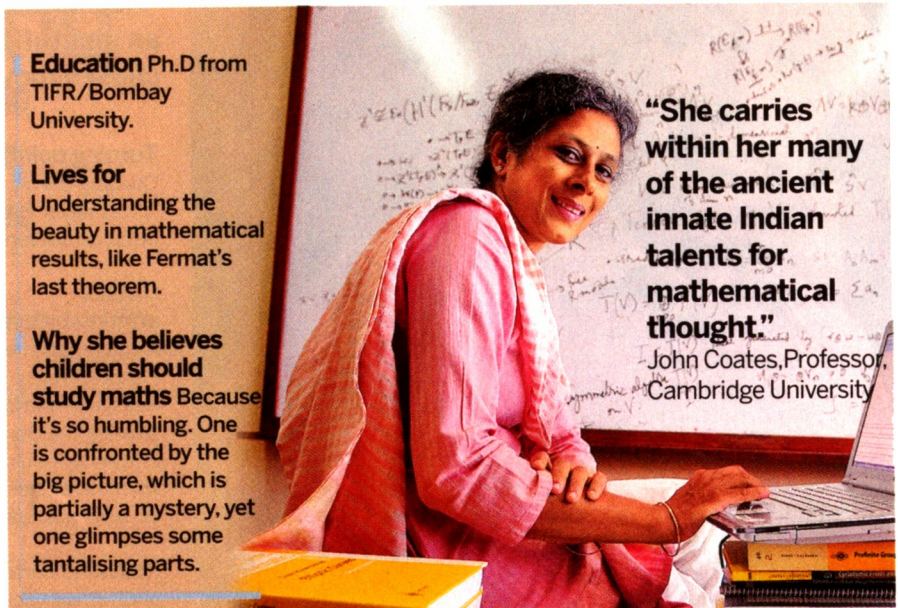
Why she believes children should study maths Because it's so humbling. One is confronted by the big picture, which is partially a mystery, yet one glimpses some tantalising parts.

MANDAR DEODHAR

developing countries by the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics, Trieste, Italy, her significance lies in not only sexing up her subject, routinely

feared by students, but also in working for its popularisation when she was at the National Knowledge Commission.

by Kaveree Bamzai



ANANT PAI 79 EDITOR EMERITUS, Amar Chitra Katha Group

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MANDAR DEODHAR

Education B.Sc from Wilson College, Mumbai.

Success mantra Imagine yourself as a child, and think of what would make you choose learning over play. It's only when you don't know you are being taught that you learn the most.

Most recent work As editor of *Tinkle* comics, published every fortnight.

MANDAR DEODHAR

Imagine your child's life without stories of the brave Shikari Shambhu, the greedy Tantri the Mantri, and the idiotic Suppandi in *Tinkle*. Now imagine your own childhood without the glorious myths of *Amar Chitra Katha*. Eminently readable due to their visual appeal and simplicity, 'Uncle Pai's' *Tinkle* and *Amar Chitra Katha* have made both mythology and history accessible to generations of children. From beautifully illustrating Krishna's narration of the Gita to the life and times of Kalpana Chawla, Pai's journey has been, as he puts it, a route to the roots. His saga of comic creation began in 1967, when he first saw people unable to answer questions like 'Who was Ram's mother'. He then conceptualised Krishna, the first title in the *Amar Chitra Katha* series but maintained that the comic series must retain a contemporary feel. Since then, the group has sold more than nine crore copies of over 400 titles. Currently, it sells about 35 lakh copies through subscriptions and off stalls every year.

by Pankti Mehta



"Pai has recreated history that children can relate to, steering it away from school books." Subba Rao, CEO, Amrita Bharti Comics